

air conditioner work overtime like having a drafty window that lets out all your energy!

Even though it didn't look very pretty, we always bought plastic insulator kits (available at home improvement stores) and placed them over our windows to keep the heat in. We also stuffed cracks with rags and blankets whenever possible. Although it was a little embarrassing when we had company over, it helped a lot.

Some other things you can do to minimize leaks:

- Use heavy curtains and/or blinds over windows. These keep the house warm in the winter, and cool in the summer.
- Place foam insulation pads behind electrical outlets and switches. These cost less than \$2 and plug holes you may not have otherwise thought about.
- Use strips of insulation around doors and windows.

You may also want to consider better insulation in your attic and crawl spaces. Heat rises and the more you can keep it from leaving through your roof, the better. We invested in this a few years ago, and even though it was more expensive than we wanted, it did make a huge difference in future bills.

3. UNPLUG APPLIANCES AND OTHER DEVICES

Take a minute to look around your house...is your toaster oven plugged in? What about lamps? Maybe a phone charger...or two? It takes just a few minutes to plug and unplug these items, and though one appliance might not make that big of a difference, a handful of them do.

DID YOU KNOW?